

PETITION ON THE AGE LIMIT FOR SOCIAL MEDIA TO THE MINISTRY OF SOCIAL AFFAIRS AND HEALTH

Dear representative of Ministry of Social Affairs and Health

Here we have collected the names of the petition from the Smartphone Free Childhood* (SFC) movement, which mainly consists of parents of children and young people. Those of us who have participated in this, appeal that an age limit should be set for social media and that social media services should check the age of users so that minors do not have access to the services. We propose an age limit of 16 years, which has been the age limit set by many experts + Australia. Parental consent should not be in place for overriding the age limit.

There has been a lot of concern on SFC's discussion channels about the negative effects of social media on our children and young people + that social media companies get to influence our children's lives.

We feel that parents have been left with too much responsibility at the moment, because e.g. restricting is very challenging in the current environment, where a social media account can be made in minutes without any checks. In addition, parents (and children) experience a lot of peer pressure, because many children have social media at a young age, and much younger than what the Finnish Institute for Health and Welfare recommends.

We would like children and young people to be able to grow up in a safe (digital) environment, where the feed of addictive and harmful algorithms, does not control their lives and where they are not available to groomers, criminals and cyberbullies 24/7. We believe that an age limit would be a really positive thing, as has been the case with a ban on mobile phones in schools, and would represent the will of a large but silent majority.

This also came up according to a consumer survey commissioned by Hintaopas**, 67% of Finns want to ban social media for children under the age of 15... But only 16% don't want to. There are also decades and hundreds of research results on a social media-free childhood, because most people have grown up without it. It is a safe path.

Nor do we see that the so-called. Dark web and unmoderated services are a problem because they require more effort and usually the way to them goes through current social media.

So we appeal to you: Set a minimum age limit for social media (16) and make it mandatory for social media companies to do a proper + functional age limit check, under the threat of fines.

*Smartphone Free Childhood (SFC) – is a movement (www.smartphonefreechildhood.fi) made up of parents of children who want to delay the use of smartphones and social media until later in life. The movement has its origins in England, but the country-specific movements are independent.

**Hintaopas consumer questionnaire (published 27.1.2026)

This appeal has been participated by: (list of names to be added):